

This category was probably one of the most difficult to find an Open Source alternative that lets you do everything that the paid ones did. Out of the two good Open source alternatives listed above, Jahshaka hasn't been updated since the year 2008 and is quite outdated in terms of features. So that leaves us with Blender. Blender isn't actually a dedicated post production tool but rather a 3D modelling software that comes with advanced compositing and video editing capabilities. To check how it fairs alongside the paid software we'll be comparing it with After Effects, which though not the most advanced software on the list, is the most popular one among the intermediate users. Blender's compositor can do many things that After Effects can, if not all. There are also a couple of things like 3D object modelling and animation, where Blender might even fair better than After Effects. But if we are being totally honest with you, currently there is no Open source software available in the market that lets you do all that is possible with After Effects, though they are slowly getting there. But Blender will take care of most of the needs of an intermediate user and is a fun to use piece of software that can be used to make some amazing things.

Pros: What it can do

The open source software is not only available on all the three major platforms, namely Windows, Linux and OS X but also runs on Unix, Solaris and Irix. Moreover, there also exists a portable version of the software. So no hassle of installing the software on every computer you want to work on. Just carry all your project files and the software in a pendrive and take it anywhere you go. Blender has some amazing 3D modelling and animation capabilities, which you would have realized if you had seen some of the short films created using the software ([link:dgit.in/blendersf](http://link.dgit.in/blendersf))

Another nice addition to Blender's feature set is the capability of importing 3D models created in 3DS Max (.3ds format), Lightworks (.lwo format) and also .obj files. The software can also export the models you create in it into .3ds and .obj files so that it can be used by other software.

A main part of every post production tool is its compositing capabilities. Blender features a node based compositor unlike After Effect's Layer based compositor which though a little bit more difficult to master, is more effective when working on a complex project where you would have to switch between numerous layers. Still Blender's compositor isn't as advanced as After Effect's.

Blender has been coded in Python and there exist a number of plug-ins and textures coded by developers that can be downloaded off the resource